

Statements

(internal, RU only; base for external reviewers; and post-tenure review)

Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn

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1 Background Information

Hopefully, I am just overthinking, and it will be quick and easy, but just in case I provide here extra background information that should be helpful if the case gets difficult.

My home department, public policy and administration (DPPA), is a peculiar department. One peculiarity is emphasis on activism, community engagement, and service. Rutgers-Camden is R-2 “High Research Activity” institution—we should be mostly about research, say about 70% research, 20% teaching, 10% service, but DPPA is opposite: 70% service (mostly activism), 20% teaching, and 10% research. Another peculiarity is that there are some very strong personalities. Opinions are equally strong.¹ All I am asking for is a fair evaluation based on objective evidence. Please cross-check DPPA’s faculty opinions with the evidence available in the packet. For instance, in addition to DPPA’s opinion on my service, see my service record in CV. Also note that I am facing a cross-department friction: I led the creation of, I support, and teach in Data Science program, which is outside of my home department, DPPA. There is also departmental friction with the Prevention Science program.²

My biggest worry is that DPPA might have solicited external letters from outside of my field. There are no DPPA faculty in happiness research—but there are some who like to have opinions about it. See what the experts in happiness research say—these should be hopefully the external letters.

¹One such strong opinion is by Paul on econometrics/statistics to infer causality. Paul is not fundamentally wrong in grand scheme of things—indeed causal inference is one way to contribute—agreed; but is only one of many ways! It’s neither necessary nor sufficient for great research! And this is not the way I have chosen to contribute in my research, and I have a right to be an independent researcher.

I am contributing in different ways than causality (most social science research is not causal by the way): I have novel ideas and able to find the right data to test them—I use complex large scale datasets to study new relationships—this is my contribution as recognized by my field.

By the way, some of the greatest research out there in the very top journals like Nature or Science is not causal—it’s just a data visualization like a scatterplot, and yet it is the top of the top, cream of the crop research, that beats any other research causal or not. So don’t tell me that for a research piece to be good it has to be causal—it is simply not true. And this very top research in Nature or Science—what makes it the very top is the research idea and the right data, not causality—this is what I aspire to, and this is my research strength and direction—novel ground breaking research ideas and great data without causality.

One problem with Paul’s ideas is that he is in education area where causality is important—but my area is urbanism. Urbanism is my independent variable—it can hardly be studied in a causal way, it is an organic process in the real world—almost all research in this area, my area of research, is not causal.

Yet another point: economists (like Paul) also have it wrong that complex stats and econometrics and instrumental variables etc give you causality—no they don’t! They just get you little closer if done right, but the only way to claim causality is experiments (or sometimes quasi-experiments). Causality is not about stats or models, it is about research design. So if you want to do causality right in my area of effect of cities on happiness, you would have to assign people at random to cities and rural areas—it’s impossible.

Still, some of my research argues that the causality may be present. (But again it is impossible to know for sure without (quasi-) experiment that is not feasible in my area.) Instead, I argue directional relationship, or possibility of causality if you will, by paying attention to control variables and avoiding overcontrol bias (Golden et al. 2026), using fixed effects (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2023, Okulicz-Kozaryn and Mazelis 2018) and even before-after comparison group design (Okulicz-Kozaryn and Valente 2026).

²I had great students from Prevention Science in my classes and I want to support them—now being on one dissertation committee and chairing one dissertation—but Patrice tells me I should not be doing that. Again, I don’t think I should be punished in my evaluations for supporting students from another program. We are all on the same team—DPPA could be more collegial with other programs on campus.

2 Research

I am in the field of social indicators, quality of life, wellbeing, and life satisfaction. The main journals are *Applied Research in Quality of Life* (ARIQ) and *Social Indicators Research* (SIR).³ The main academic/professional organization is International Society for Quality-of-Life Studies (ISQOLS). My field is thinner on theory than other social science, (post-)positivist, and quantitative—about patterns, relationships, and effects—but rather correlational than causal. (Quasi-)experiments are very rare, and there are more descriptions and visualizations than economics and statistics. My field is somewhere between geography, sociology, psychology, and philosophy.⁴ My interests have been broad, including politics (Okulicz-Kozaryn et al. 2014), volunteering (Morawski et al. 2022), and agency (D'Italia and Okulicz-Kozaryn 2025).

All research is (supposed to be) new in some sense, but my research is more original/innovative than most. Many contribute only incrementally, say by slightly improving a model, adding an interaction or instrumental variables. My contribution is new ideas—human creativity is even more important in current AI age. I have creative ideas, and then able to find the right data to test them. I was the first to look at several relationships:⁵ effect of energy use on happiness (Okulicz-Kozaryn and Altman 2019), effect of social v individual religiosity on happiness across countries (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2010), and on trust in the US (Valente and Okulicz-Kozaryn 2021); effect of religiosity on creativity across space (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2015b).

My main area of research has been urban-rural happiness gradient, a term coined in my early paper on the topic: “An urban-rural happiness gradient” (Berry and Okulicz-Kozaryn 2011). This line of research is not entirely new—it has been studied in a quantitative fashion in a limited way in the 70s and philosophically since antiquity—but mine are the first studies in modern times.⁶ And I have a related line of research looking at livability of places: Okulicz-Kozaryn (2013), Okulicz-Kozaryn and Valente (2019a).

My urban-rural happiness gradient research includes careful gradient elaboration (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2017) and theory-rich Okulicz-Kozaryn and Mazelis (2018). As the research has matured, I added: generational differences (Okulicz-Kozaryn and Valente 2019b), growing-up (Okulicz-Kozaryn and Valente 2020), panel data (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2023), elaborated happiness measurement (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2024), and Covid19's effect (Okulicz-Kozaryn and Valente 2026). Finally, Okulicz-Kozaryn and Valente (2021) shows that urban unhappiness is common across countries.

I work with students to explore the gradient further: examined population change instead of level (Okulicz-Kozaryn et al. 2024), and turned to non-WEIRD (Western, Educated, Industrialized, Rich, and Democratic) societies: India (Deb and Okulicz-Kozaryn 2023), Egypt (Mikhaeil et al. 2024), and Colombia (Okulicz-Kozaryn et al. 2026).

I am at the forefront of the urban-rural happiness debate.⁷ Some may argue that happiness has little to do with public policy and administration—nothing further from the truth⁸

Near-future trajectory remains similar: mostly urban-rural happiness gradient and regional happiness, adding Latin American focus (Okulicz-Kozaryn and Martinez 2025). I plan to spend more time on grant writing to grow my research group, hire students and post-docs, and do course buy-outs.⁹

³Journal of Happiness Studies has shifted towards positive psychology and happiness economics. ARIQ is the flagship journal of ISQOLS.

⁴Geography is a notable part of it—my research intersects with geography: regions, and especially urban-rural gradient. This is a subjective description of the field, or rather sub-field, and this is where I fit. There are other sub-fields, notably positive psychology and happiness economics—they are related but different in important ways. My field is well described by its pioneer, Alex Michalos: Michalos (2014b,a).

⁵In quantitative way, focusing on and elaborating the relationship (not just listing among others or controlling for it). You will see in my many papers that the idea is indeed the first of its kind—nobody has looked at the relationship before in this way.

⁶There is a 30-40 year generational gap between mostly 70s and very few in early 80s versus my first study in 2009.

⁷For instance see the discussion in framing essay IV in Edited by Pia Heike Johansen and Fisker (2022). Likewise the literature has picked on “energy-happiness paradox”—the term that I have coined (Okulicz-Kozaryn and Altman 2019), for instance see: <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S0277953625011669>, <https://link.springer.com/content/pdf/10.1007/s13132-026-03228-8.pdf>, and <https://link.springer.com/content/pdf/10.1007/s10902-025-00860-0.pdf>.

⁸See Diener (2009) and my own Okulicz-Kozaryn (2016). Likewise, there are clear policy implications of my work, for instance see (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2015a, Okulicz-Kozaryn et al. 2014, Okulicz-Kozaryn and Golden 2017). My numerous Cities papers have dedicated takeaways for policy/practice section, e.g., see recent (Mikhaeil et al. 2024, Deb and Okulicz-Kozaryn 2023, Okulicz-Kozaryn and Valente 2022), and even if the section is missing, there are still policy implications, e.g., Okulicz-Kozaryn and Valente (2021).

⁹I already spend more time on http://pivot.proquest.com/funding_opps/ and collaborate with Todd Regn (RU-Camden grant expert) on grant ideas.

Since 2017, when I have submitted my materials for promotion to associate professor with tenure, I have published 37 peer-reviewed articles, including 7 in *Cities*, a journal with impact factor (IF)=8.1, higher than the top journal in public administration in the US,¹⁰ *Public Administration Review* with IF=7.2.¹¹ Since 2017 I have also published 4 articles in *Social Indicators Research*, and 9 in *Applied Research in Quality of Life*, both leading/main journals in my field. I am also collegial and collaborative—I've coauthored with over 20 authors (Scopus), and my citations more than tripled (Scopus) or doubled (Google Scholar) since 2017.¹²

¹⁰I am in a department of public policy and administration in the US.

¹¹<https://www.scimagojr.com/journalsearch.php?q=16956&tip=sid> and <https://www.scimagojr.com/journalsearch.php?q=17167&tip=sid>

¹²And my citations on Google Scholar after having stalled for 5 years (haven't stalled on Scopus) are set to increase from 350 in 2025 to over 400 in 2026: On April 28, I'm cited at 143, it's 118th day of the year, so I have $143/118 = 1.2$ citations per day; $1.2 * 365 > 400$. Scopus: <https://www.scopus.com/authid/detail.uri?authorId=23061538900>; Google Scholar: scholar.google.com/citations?hl=en&user=pz9RYloAAAAJ. Note there also used to be my department (DPPA) metrics at researchwithrutgers.com but it appears to be down as of May 15 2026—still the underlying data are at scopus.com.

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3 Teaching

Something I have dreaded as a student, and promised myself I won't do on the other side as an instructor. Style over substance: prioritizing appearance, aesthetics, and presentation over actual quality, meaning, and functionality—it looks and sounds impressive but lacks value, real utility—just like with much of social science prose.¹³ Most instruction was unnecessarily fluffy and ornamented, often grandiose as if the goal is to put student in a sense of awe.

Now as an instructor I skip the fluff and cut to the chase—convey practical information efficiently. Usefulness/utility is the key. Learning by doing, no memorizing—for instance, students bring their own data and we apply skills and tools learned in the class to the data, no exams. When I was a student I was forced to memorize theory and formulas and read hundreds of pages of formal texts. But I wasn't taught how to use the skills and the tools. I condense the material, make it relevant, maximize utility/usefulness with minimum effort, focus on what's most important in most accessible practical hands on way.

Students appreciate my teaching style, e.g., “left a lasting impression on me and I appreciated your approach and teaching style” and “Your passion for education has inspired and impacted me in so many ways. Your commitment to helping your students grow and learn is truly admirable. Thank you for all that you do!”

I decrease instruction and increase interaction: discussions, presentations, “flip the class,”¹⁴ and extra labs in addition to the class. Such interactive social approach seems even more important in current reality: short attention span, information overload, AI, and mental health problems. We need to connect, be at ease, have good energy, and even some fun in class—it shouldn't be tedious and gruesome, at least not all of it.

It is not watering down the curriculum. I provide plenty of extra/bonus materials so that it is customized to a student, doesn't overwhelm with unnecessary stuff, but provides enough depth and individual learning path. Pleasant learning experience matters, but so do outcomes.

I want my teaching to produce results. Learning (motivation, too) is the direct result. But then comes transfer of knowledge, ability to apply that learned information. We need results either in academia or outside of it.

Since 2020, I graduated 4 PhDs, they all have a job. One is at SIPRI (Stockholm International Peace Research Institute), a think-tank ranked 11th or 31st worldwide.¹⁵ Another one at Virginia Tech and the other 2 were employed at Rutgers when graduated. My students publish. Since 2020, we have published 10 peer-reviewed papers with my students in good journals including 3 in top ranked *Cities* with Impact Factor of 8.1.

One highlight is that the skills learned in the classes not only work in the academic research, but also in the real world: “The classes I took with you are helping not only my scholarship, but my day job [...] I greatly appreciate it.” and “subject: Received a Job Offer [...] I would like to thank you for all of the guidance and knowledge during all of your data-related courses the past several semesters to help me get to the point I am at today.” and “since graduating I have continued to pursue more projects in the coding world. Some analysis projects, business models, [...] I appreciate all the help and motivation you gave me in class as it helped me to really see what I can come up with from all of the useful tools, how to plan and build on projects, and skills gained from having you as my professor.”

I try to guide students individually, in the grand scheme of things, teaching is about helping students become who they are, and everyone is little different. This is another reason for forcing less required material and making more available as bonus/extra for self-actualization. I make sure I am available and approachable for students spending extra time outside of classroom: working on papers, being accessible via zoom and in person, including when on sabbatical. Now in Spring 2026 I am on sabbatical, but I still have 4 students enrolled in my dissertation hours, and I work with other students on papers informally.

Two final points on my teaching philosophy. I support public/civic service/engagement in my teaching. All my classes encourage

¹³See <https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s11192-012-0937-9>.

¹⁴Work on projects and homework collaboratively in class as opposed to home as done traditionally.

¹⁵<https://thinktankalert.com/rankings> and <https://guides.library.upenn.edu/c.php?g=1035991&p=7509972>

(but not force) and give extra credit for it. And I support students even after the class in their civic endeavors—see service section. But this is not activism, it is evidence based, data driven analysis and problem-solving. It is rather positivistic “what is”, than normative “what should be,”¹⁶ I support in my teaching old fashioned critical thinking, I don’t believe classroom is a place for political indoctrination of the students. I’m (post-)positivist in my teaching—I encourage students to try to get closer to the objective truth through evidence and data. Activism and political action are better left to politicians.

I concluded my teaching philosophy, now turning to technicalities. One highlight is unusually heavy curriculum development. Since coming to Rutgers-Camden in 2012, I have taught over 10 different classes, developed from scratch most of them, including 3 courses in 2023 for our new data science program. I am updating my teaching materials each time I teach a class. Also, I mostly teach methods classes, which often receive lower evaluations.

I teach, mentor, and support students from different programs. In my home department of public policy and administration (PPA), I teach regularly in Masters of Public Administration (MPA) and MS and PhD in Public Affairs, but I also teach regularly students from MS in Data science in my always cross listed PPA courses. Usually there are also few PhDs from Prevention Science, and occasionally from other departments such as Psychology, and Criminology and Sociology.

I strive to improve my teaching: I just attended cybersecurity trainings¹⁷, and attended Instructional Design and Technology (IDT) workshop on “Crafting the Learner-Centered Syllabus” in 2024. And I quite regularly read on teaching and mentoring advice, tips and tricks on nature.com, chronicle.com, and insidehighered.com.

My feature teaching preference would be to continue with the classes I have already taught, and there are plenty of them, over 10. My strength and preference is data science classes, but also happiness class that aligns with my research. I have been also developing a new class “social indicators” that would be broader than just happiness and include topics such as trust, freedom, and meaning. This would also align with my editorial position at Social Indicators Research journal.

I am interested in teaching short courses / microcredentials. I have already taught a short GIS course¹⁸ twice, informally, for my colleagues from the department and other faculty from Arts and Sciences, and for Walter Rand Institute. But I would like to teach more often and other short courses. There is an initiative to create Microcredentials and Digital Badges—I would like to participate in it.

I am 2025 recipient of department’s Jay A Sigler award for “outstanding service and dedication to students” (awarded by students); the plaque says “this award is given to the faculty member who exhibits a commitment to student’s academic development and personal growth.”

¹⁶Similar to Network of Schools of Public Policy, Affairs, and Administration (NASPAA) competency: “to analyze, synthesize, think critically, solve problems and make decisions.”

¹⁷2026 KnowBe4 Security Awareness Training, Cybersecurity Essentials: Secure Passwords, and Introduction to IT Security Policies—these enhance my classroom teaching—most of my courses involve computer coding or data science—cybersecurity matters more there than in usual social science courses.

¹⁸<https://theaok.github.io/shortGIS/>

4 Service

My service mostly builds on and derives from my main focus and strength, research. I provide such service in two main ways: 1) to the profession/scholarly field, and 2) to students.

I review papers for journals, 4-5/mo or 48-60/year as of May 2026, including the top journals such as Journal of Personality and Social Psychology and Public Administration Review (see CV for details). Reviewing is an essential foundation of scholarly fields, and increasingly in short supply—something I can attest to as a journal editor. Since January 2024, I co-edit Social Indicators Research, the leading journal in my field of quality of life and wellbeing. My editorial philosophy is to be mentor and helper, not just gate-keeper—for instance, I am often in favor of revision prior to external review (instead of desk-reject), and I try to guide the authors, especially the junior ones.¹⁹

My research-oriented service over past 6 years 2020-2026 to students is: published 10 peer-reviewed articles with students as co-authors, supervised 9 dissertations (4 graduated; 5 in-progress), served on 6 dissertation committees, supervised 6 data science master theses, served on 2 master thesis committees in other social science, and supervised 15 independent studies. I have also led brown bag seminars and organized a workshop on academic publishing.

And I am very excited about bringing to campus an award winning²⁰ junior professor from Germany as a visiting scholar for 2 months in Fall 2026: Leonie C. Steckermeier. Leonie is a productive scholar already benefiting 2 of our doctoral students—we have monthly or so zoom meetings where we are already working on papers.

I contribute service to the campus and department. Over 2018-2022 I have lead the development of a new MS in data science and associated certificate program. This was a substantial undertaking and also somewhat challenging as the newly created programs are located outside of my home department. I have been serving since 2022 as a director for data science certificate.²¹ I am currently supervising 2 courtesy appointments as volunteer researchers in the department—they work with me on research but also helped students in my class. I frequently serve as either ad hoc chair or member on Advancement and Promotions (A&P) committee. I find this service fulfilling. I contribute to promoting quality faculty in our social sciences and I learn about my colleagues. Other committee service is enumerated in the CV.

While research-oriented service is my strength and passion, and usual campus and departmental service is my duty, I am also mindful of Rutgers-Camden public/community service/engagement mission. I agree that as a public university, we also need to engage with and provide service to the public and community. I have assisted a number of Rutgers-Camden students in their community projects over past 5 years serving as a faculty advisor for, for instance: Olorunfunmi Adebajo's internship at the Camden County Community Development Office's Homelessness Assistance Unit,²² Marlo Rossi's project at Walter Rand Institute and other projects on abortion,²³ and Ojobo Agbo Eje: "Camden Health Equity Data Visualization Initiative." ²⁴

New Jersey first, but I have been civically engaged outside of the Garden State as well. For instance, I have used my data management skills to assist with data collection and management for Ohio Business Round Table, and Michigan Economic Competitiveness Study.

In the ideal world, I would like to continue with research-oriented service. In particular, I would like to increase my research group²⁵ and co-author more with students, and ideally postdocs. Chairing dissertations and leading independent studies would be also my strength and preference. I'm happy to take on more administrative duties such as editing another journal.

¹⁹I am grateful to the editor of Journal of Applied Psychology who has guided me when I was a junior author.

²⁰Publications: <https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=xjkPIhWAAAAJ&hl=de>. Awards: ISQOLS Prize for the Best Dissertation on Quality of Life, Well being, and Happiness, 2nd prize, 2023; Best PhD Dissertation of the Faculty of Human Sciences, Dissertation Award of the Otto von Guericke University Magdeburg for outstanding research achievements in the context of the dissertation, 2022; Second prize of the Fritz Thyssen Foundation for the best social science paper in German for the article "Eine Krise der sozialen Anerkennung? Ergebnisse einer Bevölkerungsbefragung zu Alltagserfahrungen der Wert- und Geringschätzung in Deutschland.", 2019

²¹See certificates at the bottom of the page: <https://graduateschool.camden.rutgers.edu/graduate-programs>

²²News item: <https://patimes.org/from-research-to-county-strategy-how-negative-learning-shaped-camden-countys-shared-housing-innovation>

²³News item: <https://theconversation.com/abortion-laws-show-that-public-policy-doesnt-always-line-up-with-public-opinion-274699>

²⁴News item: <https://camden.rutgers.edu/news/rutgers-camdens-urban-innovation-fund-fuels-transformative-community-projects>

²⁵My past external funding includes the prestigious Polish National Science Foundation (PI), equivalent of the US Natl Science Foundation.

5 Appendix

5.1 Background Information

5.1.1 Gloria's (full professor in the department) comments on my promotion packet are highly likely (100% according to AI) to be AI-generated

Using <https://app.gptzero.me/> GPTZero AI Detection Model 4.6b: "We are highly confident this text was AI generated" "Chance this entire text is... AI 100%"

I have reviewed your dossier carefully, and I believe it would benefit from additional professional editing to strengthen the overall coherence and integration of your work across research, teaching, and service. Promotion committees often look closely for clear alignment among these areas, as well as evidence of how they collectively contribute meaningful value to the field, the classroom, the institution, and society more broadly.

At present, the narrative feels somewhat fragmented and does not fully convey the significance, purpose, and impact of your work. A stronger and more unified presentation could better articulate the story behind your contributions—specifically, who your work serves, why it matters, and how it advances scholarship, teaching, and service in meaningful ways.

I hope these comments are helpful and constructive as you continue refining the dossier. Best of luck with the process.

5.2 Research

5.2.1 Notes/Footnotes

It was already indicated on my CV (also sent to external reviewers): note: this book is excluded from the promotion packet (this is a popular science book): Happiness and Place: Cities v Nature. Why Life is Better Outside of the City? Palgrave Macmillan

I am collegial and collaborative—I've coauthored with over 20 authors (Scopus): <https://www.scopus.com/authid/detail.uri?authorId=23061538900#tab=co-authors>

5.2.2 Elaboration On My Research

5.2.3 Scientometrics

As per Google Scholar https://scholar.google.com/citations?hl=en&user=pz9RYloAAAAJ&view_op=list_works&sortby=pubdate: I have more than doubled my citations since 2017, when I have submitted my materials for promotion to associate professor with tenure, from 163 to 353 in 2025.

According to Scopus <https://www.scopus.com/authid/detail.uri?authorId=23061538900>: I have had about 4 indexed publications per year since 2017, and also my citations more than doubled between 2017 and 2025.

According to <https://adscientificindex.com/> I am within the top 10% of RU scientists on H-Index (Recent) (220/2,364) <https://adscientificindex.com/scientist/adam-okulicz-kozaryn/1552726/>
(<https://adscientificindex.com/scientist/adam-okulicz-kozaryn/1552726/>)

5.3 Teaching

address low swb class eval bc on angela like cp paste all verbal stuff from 3 students incl 2 paraguay, and from my response to patrice; see notes in n.oorg in tenure/assoc-to-full

and add her transcript: keeps on getting Cs, not just me having issues with her

5.4 Letters from students

One highlight is that the skills learned in the classes work in the real world: “The classes I took with you are helping not only my scholarship, but my day job. Thank you [...] I greatly appreciate it.” and “subject:Received a Job Offer [...] I would like to thank you for all of the guidance and knowledge during all of your data-related courses the past several semesters to help me get to the point I am at today.” and “since graduating I have continued to pursue more projects in the coding world. Some analysis projects, business models, and even some fun web apps and game designs. I appreciate all the help and motivation you gave me in class as it helped me to really see what I can come up with from all of the useful tools, how to plan and build on projects, and skills gained from having you as my professor.”

And they work in academia, and students appreciate my approach and style: “I am reaching out to explore the possibility of having you as my graduate advisor. My experience in your Data Management course left a lasting impression on me and I appreciated your approach and teaching style. I believe your guidance would be invaluable in helping me navigate the academic journey towards finishing my doctoral degree.” and “This is Teacher Appreciation Week and I just wanted to take a moment to say thank you for all the hard work and dedication you put into teaching. Your passion for education has inspired and impacted me in so many ways. Your commitment to helping your students grow and learn is truly admirable. Thank you for all that you do!” and “Please know that I deeply appreciate everything you have done for me, and I recognize the many ways you have helped me grow as a scholar and, frankly, as an agentic person in general. I am truly grateful for you.”

And my classes might have even contributed to retention in the program: “I have learnt so much about my region is really unbelievable and I have enjoyed working with you a lot. So much, I am actually considering STAYING in the program because of you!”

“It was not an easy period for me, but your belief in me made a significant difference in helping me see it through. I recall one of your emails when you wrote, “...you have a passion for this, pursue it.” That statement has stayed with me. It reflected a genuine interest in my success, and I hope I am able to pay it forward.”

from:
to: Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>
date: Apr 15, 2026, 10:19
subject: Re: Request to pay open access APC from prof okulicz-kozaryn [260318-025834]

[...]Reflecting on this journey now, I just want to say that it was a great pleasure to work with you and to meet you Dr.Adam. But in this digital world, we will continue to communicate for sure and maybe do more work together in the future.

from:
to: Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>
date: Apr 23, 2026, 10:07
subject: Re: grant opportunity
mailed-by:

Dear Dr. Adam,

I hope you are doing well.

I wanted to take a moment to sincerely appreciate you for your support throughout my master's program. It was not an easy period for me, but your belief in me

I also wanted to share that I was selected as a finalist for the PhD in Global Urban Studies at Rutgers Newark, and I completed the interview process. However,

So you will definitely be seeing me again. :)

Thank you again for everything you've done to support me. I truly value your guidance

Warm regards

From:
Sent: Wednesday, April 8, 2026 12:19 AM

To: Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <ao264@camden.rutgers.edu>
Subject: Fw: SEVIS Data Pull 4/6/2026 - Fall 2026

Dr. Adam,

I would be remiss if I didn't share that my day job includes working in Python all the time. The Director of the Office of International Students sends an Excel file each week that is essentially a data dump, and I've used all three of the classes I took with you to make sense of it each time. Without what I learned in your classes, it would just be a random Excel file - and I like Excel. This is just a small piece of it - I was emailing late into the night with her about ban lists and communication strategy, and that entire conversation would not have been possible without the visualizations.

I also create the attached HTML, which I share each week with my colleagues, and we've been relying on it for real decision-making. The HTML is about 85% for me - I regularly echo your point about adding notes to the data. That's what people talk about more than the visuals. They look at the charts, but they look forward to my notes.

I really appreciate everything I learned in your classes and your guidance in both my professional and academic work.

From:
Sent: Wednesday, January 21, 2026 11:21 AM
The classes I took with you are helping not only my scholarship, but my day job. Thank you. Again, thank you for sharing your knowledge and mentorship. I greatly appreciate it.

indep stu dec18 2025
Hi Professor,

I really appreciate it! Thank you so much!

Again, I am truly grateful to have been a student of yours and learn so much from you.

Have an amazing holiday!

J

2024-04-26 Fri gmail "Dissertation development credit issue and thank you"
Also - thank you. I realize that I have spent so much time this semester focusing on what I needed to do that I neglected to ever tell you how grateful I have been for our work together. I know that I can be a real pain in the ass, and you have definitely experienced that more than anyone else at Rutgers - six credits of courses with me and chairing my dissertation committee! Please know that I deeply appreciate everything you have done for me, and I recognize the many ways you have helped me grow as a scholar and, frankly, as an agentic person in general. I am truly grateful for you.

<2024-04-21 Sun> gmail: class "Completed sections"
"I have learnt so much about my region is really unbelievable and I have enjoyed working with you a lot. So much, I am actually considering STAYING in the program because of you!"

sp22 swb May 12 at 15:30pm
Hi, Dr. Adam. Here are the materials of my final work. I follow the instructions of JPAM style. The word document may not be as neat as the PDF one due to some technical issues. I am excited that it is my first quantitative paper, although there is still a long way from publication. Thank you so much for your help! Your classes have improved me a lot. I had never thought about being able to use these knowledges before taking your classes. Thank you!

Besides, could we keep working on this paper during this summer? It will be my great honor to make a publishment with you.

from:
to:Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>
date:Jun 25, 2018, 8:26 PM
subject:Received a Job Offer

Dr. Okulicz-Kozaryn,

I would like to thank you for all of the guidance and knowledge during all of your data-related courses the past several semesters to help me get to the point I am at today.

I was extended an offer with the Philadelphia School District as a Strategy Analyst with their Charter School Office. The office itself oversees Philadelphia's 84 charter schools (and 70k+ students). I will be doing a lot with the student level data in regard to performance/monitoring and helping with policy/research.

Thanks Again.

from:
to: "adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com" <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>
date: Oct 17, 2023
subject: Graduate Advisor Inquiry
mailed-by: em.rutgers.edu

Good Afternoon Professor Adam,

I hope this email finds you well! My name is xxx and I had the privilege of taking your Data Management course during the spring 2022 semester. I am currently enrolled in Rutgers-Camden's new PhD program in Prevention Science. I am reaching out to explore the possibility of having you as my graduate advisor. My experience in your Data Management course left a lasting impression on me and I appreciated your approach and teaching style. I believe your guidance would be invaluable in helping me navigate the academic journey towards finishing my doctoral degree. I am a part-time student with an expected completion date during the fall 2026 semester. My preliminary dissertation topic is research around the causal effects of a need-based aid program at Rutgers-New Brunswick using a quasi-experimental design such as regression discontinuity.

Please let me know if you prefer to discuss this over a Zoom call.

Best,

from:
to: Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>
date: May 8, 2025
subject: Re: independent study

Hello Professor Okulicz-Kozaryn,

I have updated my github not only with my up to date notebook like I mentioned yesterday but I also uploaded this txt file as a writeup like you requested:
<https://github.com/>

If there is anything else you need from me, please let me know regarding the Independent Study.

I also want to say I am very happy to have taken your classes and had you to work with for this Independent study. I want to say the knowledge that you have helped me obtain along with the projects created are very much so appreciated.

I plan not only to continue research for this topic relating to music and spotify, but I am also going to take these concepts and principles for designing and working on projects with some other future endeavors as well.

And if you ever want to contact me for the future for any projects or know of any good opportunities for work or any other connections within the data science community you can contact me at:

I hope you have a good rest of your year and you enjoy your summer!

from:
to: Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>
date: Jan 25, 2026
subject: Re: independent study

Hello Professor Okulicz-Kozaryn,

This was an interesting read, I agree, it seems to be a similar idea to that one project I did for your class. Thanks for sending this along to me!

I may take some inspiration from this and add on to that previous project for continuing music analysis trends in the real world.

Also, I want to share that since graduating I have continued to pursue more projects in the coding world. Some analysis projects, business models, and even some fun web apps and game designs. I appreciate all the help and motivation you gave me in class as it helped me to really see what I can come up with from all of the useful tools, how to plan and build on projects, and skills gained from having you as my professor.

Thanks and hope all is well with you!

from:
to: Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>
cc:
date: Dec 25, 2025
subject: Christmas Greetings
mailed-by: icloud.com

Hi Prof. Adam,

Wishing you a very Merry Christmas and a joyful holiday season. I hope you're enjoying a restful break and some well-deserved time.

I've been thinking back on my time in the PhD program and remain very grateful for your guidance and support along the way. I hope the new year brings you good health, energy, and many exciting moments ahead.

Warm holiday wishes,

from:
to: adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com
date: Nov 28, 2024
subject: Inquiry about Data Management Course
mailed-by: scarletmail.rutgers.edu

Hello Professor,

I hope this email finds you well. Happy Thanksgiving!

I am writing this email after seeing the Data Management course you will be teaching in Spring 2025. If possible, I would like to know more about the course curriculum. The subject is an area of interest for me, and I am enthusiastic about enrolling in the course. I have thoroughly enjoyed being in your GIS class and I look forward to learning more under your guidance.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Regards,

from:
to: Kelly Esterly <kelly.esterly@rutgers.edu>,
Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>
date: Aug 5, 2025
subject: Capstone Project
mailed-by: scarletmail.rutgers.edu

Hello Prof. Adam,

I hope this email finds you well. I am reaching out to you for your guidance on my Capstone project in Fall '25. It was a great learning experience to take your classes. I look forward to working under your mentorship.

I am also having @Kelly Esterly on loop so she could issue the special code for the course

Looking forward to hearing from you. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Warm Regards,

from:
to: adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com
date: Oct 19, 2023
subject: Research opportunity Enquiry
mailed-by: scarletmail.rutgers.edu

Hello Professor ,

I'm xxx and I'm currently in your GIS class .It is great learning from you and I have been really enjoying studying subject.

I was wondering if there is any research /project opportunity to work with you ?
Is it possible to come visit you to talk regarding this at your convenience?

Thank you in advance
Regards ,

to: Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn <adam.okulicz.kozaryn@gmail.com>
date: May 2, 2023
subject: Thank you
mailed-by: gmail.com

Hi Dr. Adam,
This is Teacher Appreciation Week and I just wanted to take a moment to say thank you for all the hard work and dedication you put into teaching. Your passion for education has inspired and impacted me in so many ways. Your commitment to helping your students grow and learn is truly admirable. Thank you for all that you do!

Respectfully,

5.5 Service

Reviewing for journals: journals and counts are in the CV on p. 4: https://theaok.github.io/okulicz_kozaryn_cv.pdf#page=4

I want to highlight that I did all the service I was asked to do for the department.²⁶

DPPA could use some more democracy and refresh/update its structures.

Let's have more democracy, where non-full professors' voices are heard. Let's make sure people can grow, and pursue their own path.

We have these rigid structures both historical and current. Historical: someone decided probably 20-50 years ago we need certain class in core as requirements such as regional economic development, the person teaching that is long gone, the requirement still exists. Current: we have very rigid military like structure, there is one person at the top, then 3 more in a 'politbureau' and they are telling the rest what to do. Let's get rid of that and have democracy and capitalize on people's strengths and individual paths.

For instance, let's capitalize on my data science strength in teaching—we already started doing that and let's continue. I'm better fit to teach data science than regional economic development or quantitative methods that should be modernized and redesigned towards data science. I can make the case that data science (and Python, not Qgis or Stata) is the future and benefits our students. I am mindful of the fact that some DPPA students have struggled in the past, but now with AI that should not be a problem anymore.

²⁶Paul was unhappy with me once on his committee he kicked me out, then asked to join back in, but I did not join back in right away. Only later I told Patrice that if necessary I can join back in.